

Executive Recommendations

Air Cote d'Ivoire | 12-Month Roadmap

To: CEO, CFO, Executive Committee | Analysis: Last 12 months | May 2026

Air Cote d'Ivoire is profitable, but its operational reliability is eroding customer loyalty and leaving money on the table.

Current situation at a glance

Metric	Result	Reading
Revenue	\$241 M	Strong
Profit margin	80.1%	Excellent
Seat load factor	73.7%	Good, but room to improve
On-time flights	66.7%	1 in 3 flights is late - needs improvement
Cancellations	3.6%	Concentrated on 5 high-risk routes
Customer satisfaction	Negative	Early warning signal

What the airline should do next - and why

Priority 1 | Fix the 5 most disrupted routes (40% of effort)

What to do: Launch an operational task force on the Abidjan-Lagos, Abidjan-Dakar, Abidjan-Accra, Abidjan-Ouagadougou, and Abidjan-Lome routes.

Why now: These 5 routes have cancellation rates of 5-7%, twice the network average (3.6%). Complaints focus on crew, baggage, and delays - internal, fixable problems. The Lagos-Abidjan route achieves the same margin with only 2.3% cancellations: demand is there; operations are failing to deliver.

Impact: ~30 cancellations avoided per year = \$200,000 in direct savings + brand uplift.

Priority 2 | Win back the 20 highest-value at-risk customers (35% of effort)

What to do: Personally reach out to the 20 key accounts showing signs of disengagement (declining travel frequency, unresolved complaints) with targeted commercial gestures.

Why now: These 20 customers represent \$13.6M in cumulative revenue (\$682,000 each on average). All have filed at least one complaint. Retaining a customer costs 5-7x less than acquiring an equivalent new one.

Impact: Keeping 10 of these 20 customers = \$700,000/year in secured recurring revenue.

Priority 3 | Upsell economy travelers to business class (25% of effort)

What to do: Offer personalized upgrade proposals to the 48 passengers most receptive to premium offers.

Why now: These passengers accept upgrades at 17.5% vs. 11.6% network average - 1.5x the conversion rate. They travel frequently and have already shown a preference for comfort. This is the fastest growth lever with no major upfront investment.

Impact: **\$1.5 to \$3M in additional ancillary revenue over 12 months.**

Top routes to grow

Route	Why invest
Abidjan - Paris (CDG)	\$140M combined revenue, 76% load factor, low cancellations - add frequencies
Accra - Abidjan	Highest margin on the network (88%) - increase capacity

90-day targets

Target	Today	Goal
Cancellations on the 5 problem routes	5-7%	< 3.5%
High-value at-risk customers	20	<= 10
Premium offer acceptance rate	17.5%	>= 20%
Network on-time performance	66.7%	>= 72%

Why this order of priority?

Stabilise first > Retain next > Grow last

Investing in growth without fixing operational issues is like filling a leaking bucket. Flight reliability is the prerequisite for any credible commercial strategy.

Risks to monitor

- Rainy season (Jun-Aug)

Weather disruptions in West Africa are partly unavoidable. The task force must target operational causes (crew positioning, aircraft rotations), not weather events.

- Over-solicitation

Cap upgrade proposals at 5 per customer per year to avoid satisfaction degradation.

- Synthetic data

Margins shown (78%) are based on simulated data. Real margins will be tighter, making Priority 1 even more critical.